10.2 The response Object

The response object is not usually used directly, but is built up during the execution of the action and rendering of the data that is being sent back to the user, but sometimes - like in an after filter - it can be useful to access the response directly. Some of these accessor methods also have setters, allowing you to change their values.

Property of response	Purpose
body	This is the string of data being sent back to the client. This is most often HTML.
status	The HTTP status code for the response, like 200 for a successful request or 404 for file not found.
location	The URL the client is being redirected to, if any.
content_type	The content type of the response.
charset	The character set being used for the response. Default is "utf-8".
headers	Headers used for the response.

10.2.1 Setting Custom Headers

If you want to set custom headers for a response then `response.headers` is the place to do it. The headers attribute is a hash which maps header names to their values, and Rails will set some of them automatically. If you want to add or change a header, just assign it to `response.headers` this way:

```
response.headers["Content-Type"] = "application/pdf"
```

Note: in the above case it would make more sense to use the `content_type` setter directly.

11 HTTP Authentications

Rails comes with two built-in HTTP authentication mechanisms:

- Basic Authentication
- Digest Authentication

11.1 HTTP Basic Authentication

HTTP basic authentication is an authentication scheme that is supported by the majority of browsers and other HTTP clients. As an example, consider an administration section which will only be available by entering a username and a password into the browser's HTTP basic dialog window. Using the built-in authentication is quite easy and only requires you to use one method, `http_basic_authenticate_with`.

```
class AdminsController < ApplicationController
  http_basic_authenticate_with name: "humbaba", password: "5baa61e4"
end
```

With this in place, you can create namespaced controllers that inherit from `AdminsController`. The filter will thus be run for all actions in those controllers, protecting them with HTTP basic authentication.